a FlexLifeFi K-12 program

Cash & Company

TEACHER PD · MODULE 01

What Cash to Company Is

The program in three lengths. Who Cash is. The spine question.

The 30-second elevator pitch a teacher can give a parent in a hallway - and the K-12 mascot arc that anchors it.

CONTENTS

What Cash to Company Is

The program in three lengths. Who Cash is. The spine question.

01 What you will know by the end of this module /

02 The program in three lengths /

03 Who Cash is /

04 The 13-grade mascot arc /

05 The spine question /

06 What Cash to Company promises (and does not) /

07 What Cash to Company does NOT do (sensitivity baseline) /

08 The four pedagogy moves (preview) /

09 What Cash sounds like — a tiny preview /

10 The brand promise, restated /

11 Module 01 knowledge check (3 questions) /

12 Activity tie-ins /

13 Module 01 — answers to the knowledge check /

> Cash teaches kids to be clearer thinkers about money - no matter what they end up doing for a living.

Module length: ~20 minutes (read + two activities from the packet) **Activities to do alongside:** Activity 1 (Elevator-Pitch Drill), Activity 2 (The Spine-Question Walk) **Walkaway move:** the 30-second program elevator pitch.

What you will know by the end of this module

- What Cash to Company is in three lengths: 1 line, 30 words, 100 words.
- Who Cash is, why Cash is a coin, and why Cash is gender-neutral.
- The thirteen-grade mascot arc and what changes (and doesn't) across bands.
- The spine question — the one question Cash asks for thirteen years.
- The brand promise, said the way the brand says it, including what Cash to Company explicitly does NOT promise.

If a parent stops you in the hallway and asks, "what is this Cash thing?", you should leave this module able to answer in 30 seconds without slipping into hype.

The program in three lengths

1 LINE (10 WORDS)

Cash teaches kids to be clearer thinkers about money.

30 WORDS (ALWAYS-ON SHORTHAND)

Cash to Company is a K-12 entrepreneurship and financial-literacy program led by Cash, an animated coin who asks one question for thirteen years: which people, and how do you know?

100 WORDS (THE VERSION ON THE WEBSITE)

Cash to Company is a K-12 curriculum that teaches kids and teens to think clearly about money, businesses, and the world. Across thirteen years, students follow Cash — a friendly, gender-neutral animated coin — through 104 short videos, four units a year, and one question that never changes: which people, and how do you know? Cash never tells your kid they can get rich. Cash never asks about your family's money. Cash teaches one thing: how to be a clearer thinker about money — no matter what your kid ends up doing for a living.

You will be asked to recite the 30-word version on the certification quiz from memory. Practice it now. Say it out loud three times. The hardest part is resisting the urge to add a word. Don't.

Who Cash is

Cash is the program's animated host: a friendly, coin-shaped, gender-neutral character. Cash is not a teacher; Cash is a guide. Cash poses questions. Cash never gives the answer.

Three things to internalize about Cash:

1. Cash is "of the program," not human. Cash is closer to a class pet that talks than to a TV host. The teacher is the live human doing the live teaching. Cash is the persistent voice that connects concepts across grades. When a student asks "what does Cash say?" the teacher's job is to redirect: "What does your evidence say?"

2. Cash is a coin on purpose. A coin is a thing every kid in every classroom has touched. A coin is gender-neutral by default (no body, no clothes to gender, no face that codes as a particular age or race). A coin is the lowest-cost, highest-coverage symbol of money in the world. The mascot is built so a Title-I classroom and a private school both see themselves in it.

3. Cash's age "stays the same." Cash does not get older as students do. What changes is Cash's vocabulary. K-2 Cash speaks in 6–10 word sentences. 9-12 Cash builds 5-sentence arguments. The character is constant; the language is band-locked. (You will spend Module 03 learning the voice bands precisely.)

The 13-grade mascot arc

The K-12 arc is one continuous story for the student. Here is what each grade is about and how Cash shows up:

Grade	Year theme	What Cash does this year
K	Businesses help people	Cash names the helpers in the community
1	Businesses make things or do things	Cash sorts the world into make/do
2	Businesses solve problems	Cash names problems before solutions
3	Business ideas come from skills, hobbies, and needs	Cash interviews the kid about their own life
4	Businesses need a simple plan	Cash teaches a one-page plan
5	Money, pricing, and profit	Cash introduces price = cost + something
6	Businesses need systems and roles	Cash organizes the work
7	Know your customer	Cash gets specific about persona
8	Measure, improve, and operate smarter	Cash points at the numbers
9	Entrepreneurship is organized problem-solving	Cash treats failure as data
10	Ownership structure, money, and compliance	Cash names the legal stuff honestly
11	Leadership, sales, and execution	Cash teaches "show, don't sell"
12	Launch-ready entrepreneurship	Cash hands over the keys

The arc has a shape: the early grades teach noticing, the middle grades teach naming, the later grades teach making. A kid who has been with Cash since K should feel by Grade 12 that Cash has grown alongside them — but Cash has not changed. Cash just trusted them to handle bigger questions.

The spine question

This is the single most important sentence in the program. Memorize it.

> **"Which people, and how do you know?"**

That question runs through every lesson, every Capstone, every Cash video, and every conferring conversation. When in doubt about how to redirect a student, ask the spine question. When you don't know what to write on a sticky note next to a student's idea, write the spine question.

In K-2 the spine question is translated to: "What did you see? Who was it for?" In 3-5: "You picked this idea — how do you know somebody actually wants it?" In 6-8 and 9-12 the question appears verbatim. The translation across bands is a band-voice issue, not a meaning issue.

Why this question and not another? Because almost every wrong move a young entrepreneur makes — and almost every wrong financial-literacy assumption a kid has absorbed — collapses when you make them name which specific person they're talking about and how they know. The question forces concrete-before-abstract. It forces evidence-not-assumptions. It forces a student to stop performing certainty and start checking. It is the spine the program is built on.

What Cash to Company promises (and does not)

Cash to Company makes one promise: students who move through the program will be clearer thinkers about money and entrepreneurship — no matter what they end up doing for a living.

Cash to Company does NOT promise:

- That a student will get rich.
- That a student will start a successful business.
- That entrepreneurship is the right path for every kid.
- That financial outcomes are purely a matter of mindset, hustle, or effort.
- That the world is fair and that diligent kids always win.

These are not minor disclaimers. They are the spine of the brand. The entire reason the program exists is that the dominant cultural framing of money education for kids is hustle-bro: get-rich-quick, mindset-substitutes-for-evidence, six-figure-side-hustle, manifest-your-millions. That framing fails kids — especially kids whose families' financial lives don't fit the narrative. Cash to

Company is the explicit refusal of that framing. Every script, every lesson, every PD module is built to reinforce the refusal.

You will be tempted, in your first month of teaching, to slip into language that sounds like cheerleading: "you can do anything!" "the sky's the limit!" Cash never says these things. You should not say them when speaking on behalf of the program. Module 03 will give you the exact phrases to use instead.

What Cash to Company does NOT do (sensitivity baseline)

Three locked sensitivity rules. Every certified teacher signs a pledge to honor these.

1. Cash never asks about a student's family money. No "what does your family budget for groceries?" No "do your parents have credit cards?" No "raise your hand if your family has a savings account." When a financial example is needed, Cash uses neutral hypotheticals: "a family of four spends about this on groceries — let's call it a sample family." Module 04 covers the language precisely.

2. Cash never moralizes about money. Money is a tool. Cash treats it neutrally. Money is not "good" or "bad," wealth is not a virtue, poverty is not a failing, frugality is not the right answer for every household. Module 03 covers the voice rules; Module 04 covers the misconception-correction script when a student moralizes (they will).

3. Cash never engages with politics, religion, or current events. No tax-policy debates. No which-presidential-candidate-is-better-for-business. No commentary on living celebrities. Cash uses fictional businesses, established public-domain founder stories, and timeless economic concepts.

These rules exist because Cash to Company is built to land in any classroom: Title-I, private, charter, religious, secular, urban, rural, blue-state, red-state. The rules are not negotiable. A teacher who violates them is not Cash Certified; the certificate is renewable, not permanent.

The four pedagogy moves (preview)

Module 02 will spend twenty minutes on these. Here they are in one paragraph so you have the frame:

1. **Concrete before abstract.** Every concept enters through a specific person, a specific number, or a specific story before it becomes a definition.
2. **Evidence not assumptions.** Every claim is checked. The spine question is the daily move.
3. **Measurable strand outcomes.** Every lesson lands on something a student can demonstrably do — not "understand" or "appreciate."
4. **Capstone arc.** Every year culminates in a Capstone Defense; every Capstone has four checkpoints; every checkpoint is rubric-graded with the same Rubric Bank rubrics across grades.

If you remember nothing else from this PD, remember those four. They are the operating system.

What Cash sounds like — a tiny preview

Module 03 is the deep dive. Here is the flavor:

- **K-2 Cash:** "What did the helper do? Tell me what you saw with your eyes." (8 words. Concrete. Repetition allowed.)
- **3-5 Cash:** "You picked this idea. How do you know somebody actually wants it?" (13 words. Plain. Evidence-pointing.)
- **6-8 Cash:** "Revenue is loud. Contribution margin is true. Compute one number this week." (Two short sentences. Real vocabulary. Honest aside.)
- **9-12 Cash:** "You'll meet adults who skipped this part and got lucky. Don't model your career on luck. Model it on the moves." (Three sentences. Adult-coded. Philosophy-allowed. No moralizing.)

Notice what is consistent across all four bands: question-pointing, specific, hedge-honest, never gushing, never moralizing, never promising. That is the through-line.

The brand promise, restated

> Cash teaches kids to be clearer thinkers about money — no matter what they end up doing for a living.

Say it again. That sentence will be the answer to fifteen different questions a parent, an admin, a colleague, or a confused student will ask you in your first month of teaching. It is also a sentence that can be said with calm, hedged honesty by anyone — no charisma required.

Module 01 knowledge check (3 questions)

Answer mentally. Answers are inverted at the bottom of the module to discourage scrolling-to-cheat.

1. What is the spine question Cash asks for thirteen years?
2. Why is Cash a coin (name two of the three reasons)?
3. Cash to Company makes one promise. State it.

Activity tie-ins

- **Activity 1 (Elevator-Pitch Drill):** Recite the 30-word version of the brand promise three times — once to a peer, once to a non-teacher, once into a voice memo. Listen back. Note where you wanted to add a word. Don't.
- **Activity 2 (The Spine-Question Walk):** Walk into your classroom (or visualize it). Identify five spots where a student is likely to make a vague claim — a journal, a sticky note, a project corner,

the door, the parent pickup line. At each spot, write yourself a tiny note: spine question goes here.

Module 01 — answers to the knowledge check

1. "Which people, and how do you know?"
2. Any two: a coin is a thing every kid has touched; a coin is gender-neutral by default; a coin is the lowest-cost, highest-coverage symbol of money in the world.
3. Students will be clearer thinkers about money — no matter what they end up doing for a living.

One promise.

Cash teaches kids to be clearer thinkers about money - no matter what they end up doing for a living.

Cash to Company is built so a curriculum coordinator, a foundation officer, a parent, or a teacher can pick up any one of these strategic references and meet the program at full strength on the first page.

No promise of wealth. No probing of family finances. No partisan content. One question, asked patiently for thirteen years: which people, and how do you know?

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